



CYBER INSURANCE EVIDENCE PACK

Harlow & Vine Logistics Ltd

Not yet insurable · 60/100

Client	Harlow & Vine Logistics Ltd
Industry	Freight & warehousing
Employees	68
Client contact	Dawn Whitmore, Operations Director
Assessed on	2026-08-22
Assessed by	Jordan Vale
Method	On-site review 18 Aug + walkthrough of M365, Datto and Veeam consoles
Policy renewal	2026-11-01
Broker	Kelmore Risk Partners
Prepared	22 August 2026

Readiness summary

60

OUT OF 100

Not yet insurable

One or more controls that carriers treat as a precondition are missing. Expect a decline, or a policy with exclusions covering exactly the losses these controls prevent.

7 meeting expectations **10** likely to be queried **4** likely to fail

Blocking issues

One control that carriers treat as a precondition of cover is not currently met: **Backups and tested recovery**. Until this is resolved, expect a decline or a policy that excludes the losses it prevents.

Assessor's summary

Harlow & Vine run a tidier estate than most businesses of their size: patching is current, encryption is complete on laptops, and the incident response plan is written down. The blocker is backups. Copies are being taken daily, but no one has restored from them, and the backup account shares everyday credentials — so on the evidence available today we cannot tell an underwriter that the business can recover from ransomware. Fixing that single control moves them out of the decline bracket. The DMARC and offboarding gaps are the next most visible on a carrier questionnaire and are both inexpensive to close before the November renewal.

Where you stand

AREA	CONTROL	INSURER WEIGHTING	ASSESSMENT
Identity & Access	Multi-factor authentication	CRITICAL	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
Endpoint Protection	Endpoint detection & response	CRITICAL	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
Resilience	Backups and tested recovery	CRITICAL	WILL LIKELY FAIL
Email Security	Email filtering and domain protection	HIGH	WILL LIKELY FAIL
Identity & Access	Access control and offboarding	HIGH	WILL LIKELY FAIL
Vulnerability Management	Patching and end-of-life systems	HIGH	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
Governance	Incident response plan	MODERATE	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
People	Security awareness training	MODERATE	WILL LIKELY FAIL
Data Protection	Encryption of devices and data	MODERATE	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

What to fix, in order

Working down this list in order removes the objections a carrier is most likely to raise. The first few items usually account for most of the difference in premium.

1 Backups and tested recovery — When did you last actually restore data from backup to prove it works?

WILL LIKELY FAIL

CRITICAL

Your answer: Never tested / not sure

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

You do not currently know whether your backups work. Most businesses that discover this discover it during a ransomware attack, when the answer arrives too late to do anything about. An underwriter will read an untested backup as no backup.

WHAT TO DO

Veeam is already licensed for the restore testing you need, so this costs time rather than money. Book a half-day with Priya before the November renewal: restore one finance file and one full server, write down the date and how long the full restore took, and enable immutability on the Wasabi bucket while you are in there. That single afternoon is what moves this report out of the decline bracket.

OBSERVED No restore has been performed since the Veeam migration in 2024. No test records available on request.

2 Multi-factor authentication — Is multi-factor authentication required for every employee email account?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

CRITICAL

Your answer: Enforced for most users, a few are exempt

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

A handful of exempt accounts is where attackers go first, and insurers know it. Carriers routinely ask who the exceptions are, and an exempt executive or finance mailbox is the version of this answer most likely to get your quote loaded or declined.

WHAT TO DO

Remove the exemptions. If a specific account genuinely cannot use MFA, document why in writing and restrict what it can reach — carriers accept a documented, contained exception far more readily than an undocumented one.

OBSERVED Entra ID Conditional Access reviewed 18 Aug. Policy applies to all 68 licensed users; four service/shared mailboxes excluded, including accounts@ which receives supplier invoices.

3 Endpoint detection & response — What protection is installed on your computers and servers?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

CRITICAL

Your answer: EDR software, but nobody is actively watching the alerts

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

The tool will spot an attack in progress, but only if somebody reads the alert.

Ransomware is typically deployed outside business hours precisely because nobody is looking. Insurers ask specifically whether alerts are monitored, and an unmonitored tool earns little credit.

WHAT TO DO

Have your IT provider take on monitoring and response for the alerts, so a detection at 2am produces action rather than an unread notification.

OBSERVED SentinelOne installed and licensed, alerting to an unmonitored shared mailbox. No out-of-hours response arrangement in place.

4 Endpoint detection & response — What percentage of your computers and servers have that protection installed?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

CRITICAL

Your answer: 92%

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

The uncovered machines are the ones that will be hit. Underwriters read anything short of near-total coverage as a gap they cannot size, because neither can you.

WHAT TO DO

Reconcile the list of protected machines against your actual asset list and close the difference. The machines missing from an inventory are usually old servers, which are also the most vulnerable ones.

OBSERVED Console shows 61 of 66 known endpoints enrolled. The five missing are two warehouse scanners and three machines in the Ipswich depot rebuilt in June.

5 Backups and tested recovery — Is at least one backup copy kept where an attacker on your network cannot reach or delete it?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

CRITICAL

Your answer: In a separate cloud service, but reachable with our normal logins

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

If an attacker takes an administrator login, they can reach the backups with it. Ransomware crews delete backups first and demand payment second — a backup that shares your everyday credentials is one password away from being gone.

WHAT TO DO

Move backups behind credentials that are not used for anything else, and turn on immutability so a copy cannot be deleted or overwritten for a fixed retention window.

OBSERVED Veeam to Wasabi, daily. Reachable with the same M365 admin credentials used for day-to-day administration; immutability available on the plan but not enabled.

6 Email filtering and domain protection — Is DMARC configured on your domain to stop others sending email that appears to come from you?

WILL LIKELY FAIL

HIGH

Your answer: Not configured / not sure

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Anyone can send email that appears to come from your business. The common version is a criminal emailing your customers a real-looking invoice with their own bank details — your customers lose money, and they come to you about it. Underwriters check this in seconds because it is public information.

WHAT TO DO

Publish SPF, DKIM and DMARC records for your domain and work up to an enforcing policy. This is a one-off configuration job with no ongoing licence cost.

OBSERVED Checked harlowvine.example live on 18 Aug: SPF and DKIM present and passing, no DMARC record published at all.

7 Access control and offboarding — How quickly is access removed when someone leaves the business?

WILL LIKELY FAIL

HIGH

Your answer: When somebody remembers to ask

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Former employees may still be able to reach company email and files. Beyond the obvious risk from a disgruntled leaver, these forgotten accounts are unmonitored and unprotected — attackers look for them specifically. It also signals to an underwriter that security depends on memory rather than process.

WHAT TO DO

Create a written leaver checklist, run it the day someone leaves, and audit existing accounts now against your current staff list. That audit usually turns up more than expected.

OBSERVED Three accounts found active for staff who left in the last nine months, one with access to the shared finance folder. No written leaver checklist exists.

8 Access control and offboarding — Do employees have administrator rights on their own computers?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

HIGH

Your answer: A small number of documented exceptions

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Documented exceptions are acceptable to most carriers, but each one raises the ceiling on how much damage a single mistaken click can do.

WHAT TO DO

Review the exception list periodically and remove rights that are no longer needed. Keep the written justification current — it is what makes this defensible to an underwriter.

9 Access control and offboarding — How often do you review who has access to what?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

HIGH

Your answer: About once a year

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

An annual review is enough to catch the worst drift but leaves most of the year uncovered. Access accumulates quietly as people change roles.

WHAT TO DO

Move to a quarterly review of who can reach financial systems, customer data and administrative tools, and keep the sign-off.

10 Patching and end-of-life systems — Are you still running any software or operating systems that no longer receive security updates?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

HIGH

Your answer: Yes, but they are isolated from the rest of the network

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Isolation is the right interim answer and most carriers will accept it, provided you can describe the isolation. It is still a system that will never be fixed again, so it needs an end date.

WHAT TO DO

Document how the system is isolated and what it can still reach, and set a replacement date. Carriers respond well to a dated plan.

11 Security awareness training — Do you run simulated phishing tests?

WILL LIKELY FAIL

MODERATE

Your answer: No

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Without simulations you have no idea how your staff actually behave when a convincing scam arrives — training completion tells you they sat through it, not that it worked. Carriers increasingly ask for click rates because it is the one measurable human-risk number.

WHAT TO DO

Add phishing simulation, usually bundled with the training platform, and use the results to target follow-up rather than to punish.

12 Incident response plan — Do you have a written plan for what to do when a cyber incident happens?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

MODERATE

Your answer: Written down, but never rehearsed

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

An unrehearsed plan is usually missing the practical details — who has the phone numbers when email is down, who can authorise taking systems offline. Those gaps only show up under pressure, when they cost hours.

WHAT TO DO

Run a one-hour tabletop exercise: talk through a ransomware Monday morning with the people who would actually be involved, and correct the plan where it broke. Keep a dated note that you did it.

13 Security awareness training — How often do staff receive security awareness training?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

MODERATE

Your answer: Once a year

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Annual training is the accepted minimum but decays quickly — recognition of a scam message drops off within a few months of the session.

WHAT TO DO

Move to short quarterly refreshers rather than one long annual session. Retention is markedly better and staff resent it less.

14 Encryption of devices and data — Is sensitive customer or financial data encrypted where it is stored?

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

MODERATE

Your answer: Partly / we are not sure where all of it is

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Not knowing where sensitive data lives is the more serious half of this answer. After an incident you have to tell people what was exposed, and you cannot do that if you do not know what you held or where.

WHAT TO DO

Map where customer and financial data is stored — including the spreadsheets on individual machines — then apply encryption to those locations.

OBSERVED Customer and rate data sits in Microsoft 365 and is encrypted at rest by default. Finance also maintain local spreadsheets of customer bank details on two machines; no one could say whether other copies exist.

Full response detail

Multi-factor authentication

IDENTITY & ACCESS

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

MFA is the single most common precondition for cyber cover. Most carriers will not quote a business that cannot confirm MFA on email and remote access, and several exclude funds-transfer fraud losses outright where it is missing. *Carriers treat this as a precondition of cover.*

Is multi-factor authentication required for every employee email account?	Enforced for most users, a few are exempt	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
<i>Entra ID Conditional Access reviewed 18 Aug. Policy applies to all 68 licensed users; four service/shared mailboxes excluded, including accounts@ which receives supplier invoices.</i>		

Is MFA required for remote access into your network (VPN, remote desktop, or similar)?	Yes — required for all remote access	MEETS EXPECTATIONS
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Is MFA required for administrator accounts on your core systems?	Yes — all administrator accounts	MEETS EXPECTATIONS
<i>Six Global Admin accounts, all MFA-enforced. Northgate's own delegated admin access also enforced via GDAP.</i>		

Carriers distinguish sharply between traditional antivirus and monitored endpoint detection and response. The second is increasingly a condition of cover because it is what stops a ransomware attack mid-flight rather than reporting it afterwards. <i>Carriers treat this as a precondition of cover.</i>		
What protection is installed on your computers and servers? <i>SentinelOne installed and licensed, alerting to an unmonitored shared mailbox. No out-of-hours response arrangement in place.</i>	EDR software, but nobody is actively watching the alerts	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED
What percentage of your computers and servers have that protection installed? <i>Console shows 61 of 66 known endpoints enrolled. The five missing are two warehouse scanners and three machines in the Ipswich depot rebuilt in June.</i>	92%	PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Backups and tested recovery RESILIENCE

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Backups decide the size of a ransomware claim. Carriers ask three things: are backups separated from the live network, how recent are they, and have you actually restored from them. The third question is where most businesses fail. *Carriers treat this as a precondition of cover.*

Is at least one backup copy kept where an attacker on your network cannot reach or delete it?

In a separate cloud service, but reachable with our normal logins

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Veeam to Wasabi, daily. Reachable with the same M365 admin credentials used for day-to-day administration; immutability available on the plan but not enabled.

When did you last actually restore data from backup to prove it works?

Never tested / not sure

WILL LIKELY FAIL

No restore has been performed since the Veeam migration in 2024. No test records available on request.

How often is critical business data backed up?

Daily or more often

MEETS EXPECTATIONS

Email filtering and domain protection EMAIL SECURITY

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Most claims start in an inbox. Carriers look for filtering ahead of the mailbox and for DMARC, which stops criminals sending mail that appears to come from your own domain. *Commonly asked and commonly priced.*

Do you use email security filtering beyond what your mail provider includes by default?

Provider built-in protection with the paid security add-on enabled

MEETS EXPECTATIONS

Is DMARC configured on your domain to stop others sending email that appears to come from you?

Not configured / not sure

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Checked harlowvine.example live on 18 Aug: SPF and DKIM present and passing, no DMARC record published at all.

Access control and offboarding IDENTITY & ACCESS

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Underwriters use offboarding as a proxy for whether a business has real process. Accounts belonging to people who left are a common finding in breach investigations and an easy one for a carrier to ask about. *Commonly asked and commonly priced.*

How quickly is access removed when someone leaves the business?

When somebody remembers to ask

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Three accounts found active for staff who left in the last nine months, one with access to the shared finance folder. No written leaver checklist exists.

Do employees have administrator rights on their own computers?

A small number of documented exceptions

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

How often do you review who has access to what?

About once a year

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Patching and end-of-life systems VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Carriers ask how fast critical patches land, and separately whether unsupported software is still running. Unsupported systems are a common explicit exclusion. *Commonly asked and commonly priced.*

How quickly are critical security updates applied after release?

Within 14 days

MEETS EXPECTATIONS

Are you still running any software or operating systems that no longer receive security updates?

Yes, but they are isolated from the rest of the network

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Incident response plan GOVERNANCE

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Carriers ask whether a plan exists, whether it has been rehearsed, and whether it names the carrier's own notification line. Late notification is a common reason for a claim to be reduced. *Expected on most questionnaires.*

Do you have a written plan for what to do when a cyber incident happens?

Written down, but never rehearsed

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Do you know who to call in the first hour — IT provider, insurer, and legal?

Yes — written down and available offline

MEETS EXPECTATIONS

Security awareness training PEOPLE

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Training is standard on nearly every questionnaire. Carriers look for regular training rather than a one-off induction, and for simulated phishing as evidence it is working. *Expected on most questionnaires.*

How often do staff receive security awareness training?

Once a year

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Do you run simulated phishing tests?

No

WILL LIKELY FAIL

Encryption of devices and data DATA PROTECTION

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Encryption on laptops and phones limits the reporting obligations after a device is lost, which directly limits the cost of that event to the carrier. *Expected on most questionnaires.*

Are laptops and mobile devices encrypted?

Yes — all of them, and we can prove it

MEETS EXPECTATIONS

Is sensitive customer or financial data encrypted where it is stored?

Partly / we are not sure where all of it is

PARTIAL — LIKELY QUERIED

Customer and rate data sits in Microsoft 365 and is encrypted at rest by default. Finance also maintain local spreadsheets of customer bank details on two machines; no one could say whether other copies exist.

Prepared by Northgate Managed IT for the named client. This assessment reflects the information supplied and observed at the time of review, and common cyber-insurance underwriting expectations. It is not a policy, a guarantee of cover, or a substitute for advice from your broker.

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